

CASE STUDY

From Manual Reporting to a Secure Automated Reporting Flow

A real-world process challenge focused on automation, data confidentiality, reporting accuracy, and operational efficiency.

Case Date	13 August 2026	Discussion Deadline	4 September 2026
Case Type	Process Automation & Reporting	Discussion	General Team Discussion

The Team Leader's Message

Let me explain the current process and what I'm actually trying to solve.

Right now, the department dashboard is only accessible to me and the manager. The dashboard is connected to the database I maintain on Drive.

Every month, around the 5th, the team sends me the data after they finish their audit. I then take that data, add my own comments and any team-related information, and start preparing the reports.

The problem is that we used to send the reports to clients around the 25th. However, clients found some issues in the data and now they want to receive the report by the 10th at the latest, so they have enough time to review it.

Initially, they wanted to see all the comments related to each user. But we agreed that, since they need the report much earlier, they will receive the main KPIs and the essential information by the 10th, and then at the end of the month, as usual, they will receive the full report with all the details and comments. They agreed to this.

Now, what I really want is to reduce the manual work on my side, especially the process of collecting data from the team, adding the required information, and preparing the reports for each client.

The idea is that each Senior would be responsible for a specific group of clients and would be responsible for sending their reports.

But there are a few important constraints. First, I don't want the team to have access to the database or the dashboard because the data is confidential. Second, one Senior or Agent should not be able to see another person's clients or reports. They should only have access to the clients assigned to them.

Third, I don't want the process to become a situation where everyone is manually copying data, calculating KPIs, and preparing reports. That would just move the manual work from me to several other people and still leave us exposed to human errors.

What I'm looking for is something where the team uploads the audited data around the 5th, and from that point, the process is mostly automated.

The system should take the uploaded data, perform the required calculations and KPIs, and generate the reports for each Senior based on the clients assigned to them. Ideally, the output should still be in Excel because that's the format we currently use to send the reports to clients.

At the same time, I need to have my own view where I can see everything at an overall level and review the generated reports before anything goes to the clients.

Basically, once everyone finishes uploading their data around the 5th, I want the reports to be ready as quickly as possible. That gives me a few days to review and validate everything before the Seniors send the reports to clients by the 10th.

The main goal is not just to automate the report itself. I want to redesign the whole process so that the manual work on my side is significantly reduced, the calculations and KPIs are generated automatically, the right Senior only sees the clients assigned to them, the team never gets access to the confidential database or dashboard, we minimize the possibility of human error, and I still have a central view to review and approve everything before it goes to the clients.

What This Case Will Measure

01	Problem Understanding	Can the team identify the real business problem rather than jumping directly to a technical solution?
02	Process Design	Can the team redesign the end-to-end monthly reporting process and remove unnecessary manual steps?
03	Automation Thinking	Can the team identify what should be automated, what should remain controlled by humans, and where automation creates the most value?
04	Data Security	Can the proposed approach enforce confidentiality and ensure each person only accesses the clients and reports assigned to them?
05	Data Quality & Controls	Can the solution reduce human error through validation, controlled inputs, calculations, and approval steps?
06	Business Value	Can the team explain how the solution reduces workload, improves turnaround time, and gives the Team Leader enough time for review?
07	Scalability	Can the solution continue to work as the number of clients, Seniors, or reporting requirements increases?

Discussion Prompt

By 4 September 2026: Come prepared to discuss how you would approach this problem. Focus on the process, risks, controls, automation opportunities, and user experience. You are not expected to start with a specific technology or tool—the goal is to demonstrate how you think about the problem.